Timothée **Schmude**

Scientific Researcher in Trustworthy AI · PhD in explainable and contestable AI

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Summary

Researcher in explainable AI, human-centered design, and trustworthy AI policy. I investigate how AI systems can be responsibly integrated into society and how transparency can support people in understanding and challenging these systems. My latest projects examine AI disclosure in research, participatory design processes with public sector institutions, and regulatory implementation of explainable and contestable AI.

Education

University of Vienna — *Vienna, Austria*

PhD in Computer Science: Explainable AI — *Mar. 2022 – Aug. 2026*

- Thesis: "Explanations for AI Novices: Understanding, Deliberating, and Contesting Algorithmic Decisions", defended on the 20.08.26
- Research visit at Télécom Paris, France, from 10/24 to 02/25 on the topic of explainability and contestability in AI regulation.

University of Cologne — *Cologne, Germany*

M.A. in Professional Writing — *Oct. 2019 - Feb. 2022*

- Thesis:"Texts of the Future: How Writing Machines Are Changing Literature"

University of Cologne — *Cologne, Germany*

M.A. in Information Processing — *Oct. 2018 - Apr. 2021*

- Thesis: "Information Extraction from Legal Documents: An Analysis of Performance and Interpretability"

University of Bayreuth — *Bayreuth, Germany*

B.A. in Media Studies — *Oct. 2015 - Oct. 2018*

- Thesis: "On the Form and Necessity of Digital Ethics in Cybernetics"

Selected Work Experience

Joint Research Centre (JRC) of the European Commission — *Seville, Spain*

Scientific Researcher in Trustworthy AI — *Aug. 2026 – current*

- **Science for policy**: Providing scientific contributions to EU AI policies such as the EU AI Act and the Digital Services Act.

Joint Research Centre (JRC) of the European Commission — *Seville, Spain*

Scientific Trainee — *Mar. 2026 – Aug. 2026*

- **AI Disclosure Design**: Coordinating and conducting a research project to develop disclosure method for the use of AI in research.
- **Red-teaming AI Companions**: Contributing to concept and methods of a qualitative evaluation methodology of AI companion platforms.

University of Vienna — *Vienna, Austria*

PhD Student — *Mar. 2022 – Mar. 2026*

- **Empirical Qualitative Research**: Conducted interviews with 100+ participants, e.g. case workers, job-seekers, researchers, AI policy experts.
- **User-Centered Design**: Designed, programmed, and user-tested website for social counselors to understand and contest algorithmic decisions.
- **Project Acquisition**: Acquired and conducted research project on the evaluation of a tax law chatbot funded by the Austrian Chamber of Labor.
- **Student Supervision**: Supervision of three master and two bachelor theses, resulting in two papers and a student research award.
- **Lecturing:** Lectured and graded courses on Human-Computer Interaction, Visualization, Data Mining. Profile: ufind.univie.ac.at.

Télécom Paris | Institut Polytechnique de Paris — *Palaiseau, France*

Research stay — *Oct. 2024 – Jan. 2025*

- **Empirical Qualitative Research**: Conceptualized and conducted interview study with AI policy experts from JRC, EP, universities.
- **Interdisciplinary Project Coordination**: Initiated and led international research project with co-authors from law, design, sociology, HCI.
- **Stipend Recipient**: SSHN stipend granted by Campus France for visiting researchers in France.

University of Cologne — *Cologne, Germany*

Lecturer — *Oct. 2021 – Feb. 2022*

- **Course Implementation**: Created and prepared weekly lectures for 25 students on Deep learning architectures and applications.
- **Programming Exercises in Python**: Built notebooks and programming problems using Deep Learning library TensorFlow.

molytix GmbH — *Cologne, Germany*

Software Developer — *May 2021 – Mar. 2022*

- **Programming and Data Analysis in C#**: Developed .NET web-app for calculation, analysis, and presentation of ticketing data.
- **Product Development with GTFS Data**: Built product prototypes for analysis of transit specification data.
- **Homepage Launch:** Designed, planed, and launched new company homepage molytix.com.

Selected Publications

Humans-in-the-Contestability-Loop: Designing for Social Counselors to Understand and Challenge Algorithmic Decisions. *FAccT '26, Montreal*

Timothée Schmude, Daniel Pahr, Laura Koesten, Torsten Möller, Sebastian Tschiatschek *2026*

- In: ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transaprency (FAccT) '26, Montreal, Canada, 1749–1783. doi.org/10.1145/3805689.3812271

Two Means to an End Goal: Connecting Explainability and Contestability in the Regulation of Public Sector AI *FAccT '26, Montreal*

Timothée Schmude, Mireia Yurrita, Kars Alfrink, Thomas Le Goff, Sebastian Tschiatschek, Tiphaine Viard *2026*

- In: ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transaprency (FAccT) '26, Montreal, Canada, 3078–3104. doi.org/10.1145/3805689.3812309

Better Together? On the Design and Use of Explanations to Support Novices in Individual and Collective Deliberations about AI *IJHCI*

Timothée Schmude, Laura Koesten, Torsten Möller, and Sebastian Tschiatschek *2026*

- In: International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction (IJHCI). doi.org/10.1080/10447318.2026.2650562

Start Using Justifications When Explaining AI Systems to Decision Subjects *Digital Humanism 2025*

Klára Kolářová* and Timothée Schmude* *2025*

- In: Hagedorn et al. (eds) Digital Humanism. DIGHUM 2025. Springer, Cham. doi.org/10.1007/978-3-032-11108-1_14

Information That Matters: Exploring Information Needs of People Affected by Algorithmic Decisions *IJHCS*

Timothée Schmude, Laura Koesten, Torsten Möller, and Sebastian Tschiatschek *2025*

- In: International Journal of Human-Computer Studies, Vol. 193, 2025. doi.org/10.1016/j.ijhcs.2024.103380

On the Impact of Explanations on Understanding of Algorithmic Decision-Making *FAccT '23, Chicago*

Timothée Schmude, Laura Koesten, Torsten Möller, and Sebastian Tschiatschek *2023*

- In: ACM FAccT '23 Conference, Chicago, IL, USA, 959–970. doi.org/10.1145/3593013.3594054

Selected presentations

Presentation at CNIL - Commission Nationale de l'Informatique et des Libertés *Paris, France*

Speaker *May 2025*

- Seminar on explainability and contestability as means of regulations in the public sector. Presented to the French data protection authority.

AI for the Judiciary *Wiesbaden, Germany*

Keynote speaker *Oct. 2023*

- Introductory presentation to AI and explainability at workshop organized by the Hessian Ministry of Justice.

Lecture Series "Democracy and Digital Revolution" *Vienna, Austria*

Presenter *Dec. 2022*

- Presentation of empirical findings and current work in project "Interpretability and Explainability as Drivers to Democracy".

Extracurricular Activity

AI and Human Rights Working Group: Young Section *Vienna, Austria*

Member *Nov. 2023 – Nov. 2025*

- Collaboration on publications and projects in the intersection of law and AI, funded by the Austrian Research Society.

Vienna Aid Organization *Vienna, Austria*

Volunteer teacher *Dec. 2023 – Sep. 2024*

- Weekly supervision and assistance in children's homework groups.

AI Campus Digital Learning Platform *Cologne, Germany*

Fellowship recipient *Sep. 2021 - Sep. 2022*

- Stipend to integrate and evaluate educational resources for AI and connect to AI lecturers throughout Germany.

Languages

Levels and acquisitions

- **German**: native. **English**: C1 (working language, university courses). **French**: B2 (university courses, research stay in France).